cross-section of local people of Indian origin, Sikhs as well as Hindus.

What I gathered at the end of my visit to Canada, and which was to remain valid after my interactions with friends and relatives from the west coast areas of the US, is summed up below:

1. The moderate Sikhs had gradually started losing control over the management of some of the older gurudwaras in Toronto, Vancouver and its suburbs, and in the San Francisco, Sacramento and Yuba city areas of the US to Sikh hardliners. While they were trying to regain control of those gurudwaras, the developments in Punjab had made their task difficult, if not impossible.
2. The peaceful, harmonious and friendly relations which existed between the Hindu and Sikh segments of the local Punjabi population were getting vitiated because of the communal divide taking place in Punjab, in which the Indian press, especially from Punjab, divided on communal lines, was playing a significant part. The local Indian missions were also not doing anything to improve the situation.
3. Earlier, hardly anybody would mention the word ‘Khalistan’ at social get-togethers. It was almost taboo. But now, some persons were showing inquisitiveness and wanted to know why it had become a matter of debate in Punjab. Some of the more knowledgeable ones were a bit surprised at the way Bhindranwale was being patronized by some senior Congress leaders.
4. There was general concern and apprehension amongst the moderate Sikhs that if urgent corrective measures were not taken by the Government of India and by Indian missions abroad, a minuscule minority of hardliners may sideline the silent majority and carry forward their anti-India agenda.

In that connection my friends and contacts made the following suggestions: